Ira Akbar

Senior Product Designer

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Product designer who works across product, sales and deployment. I've shipped AI products that work across Indian languages, literacy levels and enterprise operations. Today I own a Voice AI platform at 11M monthly calls, deployed for Aditya Birla Capital, Zepto and Tata Croma.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founding Product Designer · Design Lead | Hunar.ai

Bengaluru | March 2024 - Present | Series A

Product & Design

- Owned product strategy, roadmap and end-to-end design for Hunar Voice, a multilingual Voice AI platform, leading a team of 4 as monthly calls grew from 3.1M to 11M (Mar-Sep 2026).
- Drove the shift from an API-operated service to a self-serve SaaS platform, owning information architecture, onboarding, campaigns and billing. Cut client time-to-first-campaign from months to a few days, removing an operations bottleneck to growth.
- Defined Hunar.ai's brand identity and design systems across products: Hunar Voice, used by 20+ brands and self-serve users, and Hunar Connect, a hiring CRM used by 50+ clients.
- Led Hunar Disha, a new AI career assistant product line, from 0 to 1, owning discovery, product and design. Validated it through a concierge MVP with 40 pilot users and 8 candidates placed, and shipped a CV tailoring tool with Lovable and ChatGPT.

Deployments & Growth

- Ran pre-sales demos, solution design and pilot deployments, designing hiring workflows that converted into signed contracts and live pilots for clients like Tata Croma and Lloyds Metals and Energy.
- Built and deployed custom Voice AI solutions for Zepto and Aditya Birla Capital across operational use cases, on the Hunar Voice API with Claude Code, GCP and n8n. Win-back flows converted 3% of leads previously marked not engaged.
- Built internal prompt-writing tools with Claude and ChatGPT, cutting agent setup from 2 days to a few hours; the approach now shapes an in-product context layer and prompt rewriter.
- Shaped Hunar's investor narrative and fundraising decks across rounds including the Series A, created sales collateral and launch communications, and represented Hunar as a speaker at the India AI Impact Summit 2026.

Consultant UX Designer | Kotak Securities

Mumbai (Remote) | September 2023 - February 2024

- Initiated Kotak Neo's first AI feature, a conversational investing assistant, defining the concept and designing the proof of concept that informed its beta launch.
- Restructured information hierarchy on StockCase and SipIt using scroll and click data, and A/B tested copy to improve feature discovery.

Product & Design | Quash

Bengaluru | June 2023 - January 2024 | Founding Team - Independent collaboration

- Designed the SDK integration experience and dashboard for a mobile app testing platform, taking it from 0 to 1 through beta as part of a seven-member founding team.
- Led product discovery, turning customer feedback into product improvements that supported eight client onboardings, including Ola, Rebel Foods and BetterHalf.

WORK EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

Product Designer | Parallel HQ

Bengaluru | September 2021 - June 2023

Judges Intelligent Virtual Assistant (Jiva) Case study
Researched judicial workflows in the Karnataka High Court and designed an AI assistant MVP to help judges find and reference case documents during hearings.

Apperture Product Analytics Tool Case study
Designed a 0-to-1 analytics platform spanning query building, data exploration and an embedded AI assistant. Brought these into a familiar spreadsheet-style workspace and defined its visual language and core interactions.

Bangalore Pulse Airport App Case study
Contributed to research and experience design for Bengaluru International Airport's loyalty app, using modular design and server-driven UI to support personalised discovery.

TOOLS

Figma | Claude Code | Cursor | Claude | ChatGPT | Lovable | ElevenLabs | Google Cloud Platform | n8n | Storybook | Mixpanel | Grafana | Metabase | Framer | Final Cut Pro | Excel | Adobe Creative Suite

SKILLS

Product design User research, information architecture, UI and interaction design, prototyping, design systems

Product ownership Discovery, roadmapping, activation workflows, behavioural analysis, A/B testing, cross-functional delivery

AI & implementation AI-assisted prototyping, multilingual conversation design, prompt design and evaluation, API and MCP integrations, workflow automation

Communication Product storytelling, presentations, public speaking, workshop facilitation

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design | National Institute of Fashion Technology, Gandhinagar
2017-2021 | 9.0 CGPA

Awarded Best Academic Performance and Most Meritorious Student.

SPEAKING & WORKSHOPS

The India AI Impact Summit 2026
Speaker | Using Conversational AI to Spot Attrition Signals | Watch talk

EkStep Voice AI Conference
Speaker | From App Drop-offs to Conversational Onboarding | Watch talk

Scaler School of Technology
Guest lecturer | Designing with Empathy

NIFT, Gandhinagar
Guest lecturer | Storytelling in Case Studies; Basics of UX Design